

Defence Corridor Makes Uttar Pradesh a Leader in Defence Manufacturing

Uttar Pradesh is no longer just the country's most populous state; it is also carving out a new identity for itself in the field of defence manufacturing. During the first Investors Summit held in 2018, Prime Minister Narendra Modi announced the establishment of two Defence Manufacturing Corridors in the country. One of these is being developed in Uttar Pradesh and has now emerged as one of the key projects transforming the state's industrial landscape. Spread across six nodes in Lucknow, Kanpur, Agra, Aligarh, Jhansi and Chitrakoot, the Defence Industrial Corridor is a key component of the Yogi Government's strategy to establish Uttar Pradesh as a major national and global hub for defence manufacturing.

So far, land has been allotted to 67 companies in the UP Defence Corridor, and investment proposals worth around ₹39,804 crore have been received. Of the 2,095 hectares of land acquired across the six nodes, 1,155.30 hectares has already been allotted to industries. Projects worth around ₹13,905 crore have already become operational on the ground. These projects are expected to generate more than 16,000 direct and indirect employment opportunities. Thus, the Defence Corridor is no longer merely an industrial project for manufacturing weapons and defence equipment; it is also emerging as a major platform for new technical and employment opportunities for the state's youth.

A New Investment Landscape

Kanpur has emerged as the first choice for investors in the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor, with investment proposals worth around ₹12,948 crore received here. Jhansi follows in second place with proposals worth ₹12,190 crore, while Lucknow ranks third with investments worth ₹4,850.67 crore. Investment proposals worth ₹4,581 crore have been received in Aligarh, ₹4,392 crore in Chitrakoot and ₹607 crore in Agra. The spread of investment across the six nodes indicates that the Defence Corridor is no longer a project confined to the state capital or western Uttar Pradesh. Instead, it is creating a new network of industrial activity stretching from Bundelkhand to central and western Uttar Pradesh. In the Kanpur node, Adani Defence Systems and Technologies Limited has commenced an investment of around ₹1,500 crore. In the Aligarh node, Verywin Defence has started production of small arms with an investment of ₹65 crore. Nitya Creations India has commenced the manufacturing of precision arms components with an investment of ₹12 crore, while Shridha Udyog has started manufacturing precision components with an investment of ₹3.70 crore.



A self-reliant nation must be self-sufficient in meeting its defence requirements rather than relying on other countries for defence supplies. Uttar Pradesh is emerging as a growth engine in strengthening the nation's defence capabilities."

Yogi Adityanath
Chief Minister

Lucknow Emerges as a Hub for High-Tech Defence Production

Within the Defence Corridor, the Lucknow node is emerging as the face of high-tech defence production in Uttar Pradesh. Aeroloy Technologies has commenced production of titanium castings with an investment of around ₹320 crore. Meanwhile, BrahMos Aerospace has started production and assembly of the BrahMos-NG missile system at a unit established with an investment of around ₹300 crore. The BrahMos unit is particularly significant because it is providing the youth of Uttar Pradesh with opportunities to engage with cutting-edge technologies in the defence sector. Young people with technical qualifications such as engineering, ITI and polytechnic are securing employment opportunities according to their skills. Across the six nodes, more than 15,000 youth have so far received direct and indirect employment. This has further strengthened the role of the Defence Corridor as an industrial cluster generating employment. The allocation of 75 hectares of land to Bharat Electronics Limited in the Chitrakoot node is another step in this expansion. With an investment of around ₹562.5 crore, an advanced manufacturing facility will be established here for the production of state-of-the-art radars and air defence systems. The project is expected to create more than 300 direct employment opportunities. The arrival of such a high-tech industrial project in a region like Bundelkhand could prove to be a major transformation for the local economy.

Eye on Global Defence Companies

The Yogi Government's strategy is no longer limited to domestic companies. Efforts to open the Defence Corridor to global investment are also gaining momentum. Defence and aerospace companies from Spain have expressed interest in investing in the Uttar Pradesh Defence Industrial Corridor. Discussions are particularly focused on potential investments in the Kanpur and Jhansi nodes. Spanish companies have expertise in advanced defence technologies such as military transport aircraft, warships, submarines, radars, electronic warfare systems, air defence, cyber defence and armoured vehicles. Therefore, the interest of foreign companies in Uttar Pradesh will not be limited merely to increasing investment volumes. It will also create opportunities for new technologies, design, research, skill development and integration with global supply chains. The possibility of joint ventures with Indian companies could further accelerate this process.